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Subject: [External] AI Action Plan
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To whom it may concern:

Hello, I am a professional artist and designer who has worked primarily in themed entertainment as well as in the realms of book illustration, fashion, and costume design. My years of experience and network of creative professionals have given me direct exposure to the interior working conditions of related creative industries such as animation, film & tv production, video games, table top & board games, advertising, product design, merchandising, and more. It is with this background that I must comment on the future of art, entertainment, and all culture which we hold dear with regards to Generative “Artificial Intelligence.”

This technology requires vast amounts of data, data which these tech companies pushing to infect every piece of our society with their product must be harvested from troves of copyrighted material. They’ve admitted themselves that the tech can’t function without this data. They’ve also admitted that they’ve been mostly running unchecked knowing that they were in essence stealing data. They’re fighting hard to tell us that “training” is different than other copyright uses, but they can give no guarantees that their tech won’t outright plagiarize. Examples of plagiarism have been found in small samples sizes using both generative image “AI” and using Large Language Model (LLM) “AI.” It cannot function without stolen intellectual property, and yet they believe they are above compensating IP and copyright holders for their work. They should not receive an exception for their sad parasitic technology—artists, writers, creatives, and even corporations deserve compensation for when their work is used regardless of who is using it!

What’s more, this technology specifically seeks to replace those that create the data on which they run. Though here, at least, we reach an interesting limit: generative “AI” is inherently derivative. It cannot innovate because it doesn’t truly think like a human, no matter what lies the tech bros tell. That, unfortunately, won’t stop employers from being duped into firing their skilled creative staff to attempt to replace them. The end result would be disastrous: artists unable to find work, entire creative industries tanking, cultural institutions shuttering, and eventually the crumbling of culture as innovation and human-made art become out of reach to the masses.

It won’t end with creative industries—CEOs of every stripe will sign up to replace every part of their workforce no matter how poorly AI assistants actually function. Imagine being stuck in endless robotic phone trees on every call to insurance, the bank, the doctor...imagine there is no human at any point that you can reach. An AI cannot be held responsible when it gives you dangerous advice—which it has already been shown to do with even common Google AI telling people to add glue to their pizza toppings. And when an AI recreates a worse, garbled version of a classic film, will it be held liable for that plagiarism? Or do the companies making it?

In short, “AI” technology is an anti-innovation, anti-creativity, anti-human grift! It’s being sold to us by empty promises when the reality is a steaming pile of stolen data and copyright infringement. The tech cannot think like a human and even feeding it all the data in the world will not create the singularity as these AI companies claim. The emperor has no clothes. Please, stand up for creative industries, protect those that make and keep culture, and let us grow to a more human-centric future. Generative “AI” allowed to run unchecked will be the beginning of a very dangerous and bleak future.

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Thank you,

Kelsey Soderstrom

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